Words for pressure and choices

Use these words with the invented cases. No personal story or account is needed.

Peer pressure

Peer pressure is feeling pushed by people of a similar age to do or choose something. It can be direct, felt without a spoken demand, or happen online. A person can choose differently and ask for help. Other people's harmful behaviour is not their fault.

Assertive

Being assertive means making a clear, respectful choice or request. It can use words, a note or a usual aid. It does not require a loud voice, eye contact or a confident feeling. A clear no should be respected. A person can seek help without saying no first.

Direct pressure

Someone tells or keeps asking a person to choose something.

Indirect pressure

A person feels they must copy a group to fit in, even without a direct demand.

Online pressure

Pressure happens in an online message or post. It may also be direct or indirect.

Exit line

A short line that can help someone ask for adult support. They do not have to say it to the person applying pressure.

A clear choice

No, I am choosing my own task.

Help and usual access

A trusted adult or school staff can help. Ask before a refusal if needed. Point, type, use an aid or exact scribe and private readback. You may pass or use the agreed supervised pause. A clear choice does not require a loud voice, eye contact or a confident feeling.

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